

Student Discipline Regulations

Khawaja Fareed University of Engineering & Information Technology (KFUEIT)

The university endeavours to develop a sense of individual responsibility on the part of each member of its community and seeks to enhance active participation of all segments, faculty, students, administration, in maintaining such standards, towards fostering and sustaining an environment of honour and trust across the spectrum. While representing himself or herself as a member of KFUEIT community, the student will maintain the highest standards of honesty and integrity. He/she will strive for these standards in his or her representations, academic pursuits, and respect for the property and individual rights of others. The student will uphold and actively follow the specific principles described in the Code.

The purpose of a code of ethics within an organization is to define acceptable standards and provide general principles of professional behaviour which should be followed by members of the organization in order to act in an appropriate moral way and to preclude misconduct. In other words, a code of conduct outlines for the members of an organization how to become true professionals by applying ethical concepts in everyday professional practice, thus enriching their respective assignments. Whereas without an institutional code of ethics, it remains impossible for an organization or institution to regulate the ethical conduct of its members across the spectrum. As a progressive and forwardlooking institution, Khawaja Fareed University of Engineering and Information Technology (KFUEIT), Pakistan ardently believes in nurturing in its students wholesome ethical discipline with a focus on inculcating in them the virtues of diligence, service, integrity, fairness, decency, respect, competence and excellence.

The KFUEIT Code of Ethics and Conduct for students flows from a set of values which include our core values as well as other universally accepted values. The KFUEIT core values embody our vision and mission. These core values permeate all our activities and form a benchmark to judge our efforts against. These core values are the qualities that we want to maximize in our students, faculty, officers and non-teaching staff. Furthermore, we believe that these core values will allow us to transform our society into an advance one. Our core values are based on our acronym so that they are easy to remember for us. Our core values are: K: Knowledge-able F: Faithful U: Useful E: Eco-friendly I: Innovative T: Tolerant A look at the shades of meaning conveyed by these core values will help us and others understand fully the impact that we intend these core values to have on our students, faculty, officers and nonteaching staff.

Knowledge-able: means well informed; learned; with great knowledge; well read; well educated; widely read; erudite; scholarly; cultured; cultivated; enlightened; aware. Faithful: means strict or thorough in the performance of duty; true to one's word; promises; vows; etc.; steady in allegiance or affection; loyal; constant; reliable; trusted; or believed; adhering or true to fact; a standard; or an original; accurate.

Useful: means able to be used for a practical purpose or in several ways; functional; practical; handy; neat; convenient; utilitarian; utility; helpful; applicable; serviceable; of use; of service; beneficial; advantageous; helpful; worthwhile; profitable; gainful; rewarding; productive; constructive; effective; efficacious; valuable; fruitful; of help; of assistance. Thus KFUEIT faculty, officers, body of students and the members of staff have an obligation to serve the cause of education in their respective spheres. They should seek to elevate the University to others above self-interest by drawing on their knowledge, values, and skills.

Eco-friendly: literally means earth-friendly or not harmful to the environment. This term most commonly refers to products that contribute to green living or practices that help conserve resources like water and energy. Eco-friendly products also prevent contributions to air, water and land pollution. Innovative: means featuring new methods; advanced and original; introducing new ideas; original and creative in thinking; original; innovatory; innovational; new; novel; fresh; unconventional; unorthodox; unusual; unprecedented; avant-garde; experimental; inventive and ingenious. For those who want to become future Leaders.

Tolerant: means showing willingness to allow the existence of opinions or behavior that one does not necessarily agree with; open-minded; forbearing; unprejudiced; unbiased; unbigoted; broad-minded; patient; magnanimous; sympathetic; understanding; charitable and lenient.

Furthermore, KFUEIT also subscribes to other universally accepted values such as social justice, dignity and worth of the person, importance of human relationships, integrity, and competence. These values further aim to identify the ideals to which students as well as faculty, officers and non-teaching staff of the University should aspire.

Social Justice: In their respective spheres, every member of the university is responsible to promote sensitivity to and knowledge about oppression and cultural and ethnic diversity. They must have access to needed information, services, and resources; equality of opportunity; and meaningful participation in decision-making at appropriate levels.

Dignity and Worth of the Person: It is incumbent on faculty, students and administrators to treat one another in a caring and respectful manner, deferring to individual differences, as well as cultural and ethnic diversity. They should be cognizant of their dual responsibility to the university and to the broader society.

Importance of Human Relationships: Relationships between and among people promote understanding and harmony, paving the way for creating and sustaining wholesome work environment. KFUEIT students as well as faculty, officers and non-teaching staff owe both to their own advantage and the larger interest of the university and society to strengthen relationships in a purposeful effort to promote, restore, maintain, and enhance the collective well-being of individuals, families, the organization, and the civil society at large.

Integrity: It is expected of KFUEIT faculty, students, and administrators to be aware of the University's mission, values, ethical principles, and ethical standards and demonstrate ethical behaviour consistent with them. They must act honestly and responsibly and promote ethical practices within the organizations with which they are associated.

Competence: KFUEIT students must continually seek to enhance their professional knowledge and skills. They should also aspire to contribute to the knowledge in their own ways and manners.

Discipline and Respect for Law: Discipline is a cardinal law of nature visible, among other things, in the orderly working of celestial bodies. Discipline is necessary in all walks of life, and forms the core of other virtues like punctuality, cleanliness and dress-code. If people do not observe discipline, the entire social fabric would crumble like a house of cards. All along physical discipline, far more important are the virtues of moral and intellectual discipline. Moral and intellectual disciplines show in the sublime traits of self-restraint, honesty, fortitude, forbearance, integrity and courage. No society or organization can function and prosper smoothly unless its members demonstrate a sense of sound discipline. Discipline is necessary for becoming good citizens and, more importantly, good human beings. Respect for law, which means not merely not doing something negative but actually doing something positive, is a manifest expression of discipline. In fact, discipline and respect for law are the distinguishing features of civilized societies across the globe. KFUEIT urges its entire community of members to observe in letter and spirit the University discipline. Respect for authority, strict observance of the rules and regulations of the University, as well as due respect to law of the land are expected all times in all situations.

While it is desirable that students should acquaint themselves with the KFUEIT Student Code of Ethics and Conduct in entirety to deepen their understanding, they are specifically required to study the code of conduct and internalize the guidelines provided therein. Significant violation or persistent deviation from this Code of Ethics and Conduct by a University student will constitute misconduct and will be a cause for disciplinary action. An appropriate mechanism built around appropriate procedures along with suitable corrective actions exists at the University to deal with such deviations and violations of the prescribed code of ethics and conduct.

JURISDICTION

This code applies to the on-campus conduct of all registered students, including the individuals using university academic resources. The code also applies to the off-campus conduct of students in direct connection with:

his code governs all campuses of the University. However, students attending at regional campuses, centres, or institutes are advised to consult their local resources for additional information or rules pertaining to those locations.

The University reserves the right to administer the code and proceed with the hearing process even if the student withdraws from the university, is no longer enrolled in classes, or subsequently fails to meet the definition of a student while a disciplinary matter is pending.

Students continue to be subject to city, state laws while at the University, and violations of those laws may also constitute violations of the code. In such instances, the University may proceed with university disciplinary action

under the code independently of any criminal proceeding involving the same conduct and may impose sanctions for violation of the code even if such criminal proceeding is not yet resolved or is resolved in the student's favour.

DEFINITIONS

PROHIBITED CONDUCT

Any student found to have engaged, or attempted to engage, in any of the following conduct while within the University's jurisdiction, will be subject to disciplinary action by the University. Any student who abandons an attempt or prevents the prohibited conduct from occurring under circumstances that demonstrate a complete and voluntary renunciation of the prohibited conduct will not be subject to disciplinary action by the University.

Academic Misconduct

Any activity that tends to compromise the academic integrity of the University or subvert the educational process. Examples of academic misconduct include, but are not limited to:

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Violation of instructions/guidelines included in the University/institutional/students' handbook etc.

Endangering Health or Safety

Destruction of Property

Actual or threatened damage to or destruction of university property or property of others, whether done intentionally or with reckless disregard.

Dangerous Weapons or Devices

Storage or possession of dangerous weapons, devices, or substances including, but not limited to, firearms, ammunition, or fireworks.

Dishonest Conduct

Dishonest conduct, including, but not limited to: knowingly reporting a false emergency; knowingly making false accusation of misconduct; misuse or falsification of university or related documents by actions such as forgery, alteration, or improper transfer; submission of information known by the submitter to be false to a university official.

Theft or Unauthorized Use of Property

Theft, or the unauthorized use or possession of university property, services, resources, or the property of others.

Failure to Comply with University or Civil Authority

Failure to comply with legitimate directives of authorized university officials, law enforcement or emergency personnel, identified as such, in the performance of their duties, including failure to identify oneself when so requested; or violation of the terms of a disciplinary sanction.

Drugs

Use, production, distribution, sale, or possession of drugs in a manner prohibited under law. This includes, but is not limited to, the misuse of prescription drugs.

Alcohol

Use, production, distribution, sale, or possession of alcohol in any manner.

Unauthorized Presence

Unauthorized entrance to or presence in or on university premises.

Disorderly or Disruptive Conduct

Disorderly or disruptive conduct that unreasonably interferes with university activities or with the legitimate activities of any member of the university community.

Hazing

Doing, requiring, or encouraging any act, whether or not the act is voluntarily agreed upon, in conjunction with initiation or continued membership or participation in any group that causes or creates a substantial risk of causing mental or physical harm or humiliation. Such acts may include, but are not limited to, use of alcohol, creation of excessive fatigue, and paddling, punching or kicking in any form.

Abuse of Student Conduct System

Abuse of any university student conduct system, including but not limited to:

Violation of University Rules

Violation of other published university regulations, guidelines, policies, or rules, or violations of federal, state, or local law. These university regulations, guidelines, policies, or rules include, but are not limited to, those which prohibit the misuse of computing resources, sexual harassment, rules for student groups or organizations, and residence hall rules and regulations.

Riotous Behaviour

Participation in a disturbance with the purpose to commit or incite any action that presents a clear and present danger to others, causes physical harm to others, or damages property. Proscribed behaviour in the context of a riot includes, but is not limited to:

Recording of Images without Knowledge

Using electronic or other means to make a video or photographic record of any person in a location where there is a reasonable expectation of privacy without the person's prior knowledge, when such a recording is likely to cause injury, distress, or damage to reputation. This includes, but is not limited to, taking video or photographic images in shower/locker rooms, residence hall rooms, and restrooms. The storing, sharing, and/or distributing of such unauthorized records by any means is also prohibited.

PART B – ENFORCEMENT OF STUDENT CODE OF ETHICS AND CONDUCT

AUTHORITY TO CHECK FOR ACTS OF INDISCIPLINE

All faculty members, administrative staff, support staff and students will be expected to monitor the observance of this code of conduct and report any such disregard or violations to relevant University authorities for taking appropriate action/remedial measures. Matters of indiscipline would be referred to the University authorities, which are authorized to check indiscipline matters and decide as per University rules, regulations and policy. Parents of those students who disobey authority and violate the code of conduct will be informed. Students may be held accountable for the acts of misconduct of their guests while on University premises or at University-sponsored activities. Students who are charged with violations of this Code of Conduct are subject to disciplinary action as per University. Every member of the Faculty shall have the power to check any disorderly or improper conduct of, or any breach of the regulations, by students in any part of the University or outside when the visit is sponsored or organized by it. Misconduct in a classroom when a student is under the charge of a teacher shall not be allowed and a punitive action such as a fine, removal from the classroom or a punishment of greater magnitude may be imposed as decided by the authority so empowered.

STUDENT DISCIPLINE COMMITTEE

The Vice Chancellor may constitute, and revise from time to time, a Student Discipline Committee. The Student Discipline Committee is to act as an inquiry committee to investigate reported cases of violation of discipline and code of conduct by students of the University and make its recommendations in accordance with University rules and regulations. In cases referred to the Student Discipline Committee, after due inquiry, it will recommend the punishment according to the gravity of the case after giving full opportunity to the defaulter to give his/her point of view before recommending the punishment.

PROCEDURE IN CASE OF BREACH OF DISCIPLINE

A teacher, a staff member or officer in whose presence or in relation to whom an act of indiscipline has been committed or who gets to know of such an act, may deal with the case himself/herself, or if in his/her view the case is one which can be more appropriately dealt by another authority or which warrants a penalty of greater magnitude than he/she is competent to impose, shall refer the case to the President Student Discipline Committee.

CASE REFERRALS

All cases of serious breach of discipline will be referred to the Student Discipline Committee for investigation. A case should be submitted as soon as possible after the alleged violation takes place, preferably within 24 hours of the violation. Those referring cases are normally expected to serve as complainant and to present relevant evidence in disciplinary hearings before the Student Discipline Committee.

PROCEDURE FOR DISCIPLINARY HEARING

PUNISHMENT OR PENALTY FOR ACTS OF INDISCIPLINE

Punishment or penalty for acts of indiscipline shall be according to the gravity of the case and may be any one or more of the following:

Minor Punishments

APPEALS

RUSTICATION

EXPULSION

COMPENSATION FOR LOSS

The Dean of the Faculty, or any teacher or officer to whom he may delegate the powers, may instruct a student to pay compensation for any loss or damage to property belonging to the University, public authority, a fellow student or an employee of the University, caused by a willful act or gross negligence of the student. If the student does not pay such compensation within a specified period, the Dean of the Faculty will proceed against the student in the manner as prescribed in these regulations.

INTERPRETATION

If any question arises regarding the interpretation of these regulations the matter shall be deliberated by the academic administration consisting of Head of the Department, Controller of Examinations, Registrar, Deans and Vice Chancellor and their decision thereon shall be final. In all cases where the regulations are silent, the decision of the Vice Chancellor shall be final.

REMOVAL OF DIFFICULTIES

If any difficulty arises in giving effect to any of the provisions of these Regulations, the Vice Chancellor in individual cases may make such decision, not inconsistent with the spirit of these Regulations, as may appear to be necessary for the purpose of removing the difficulty, provided that such a decision is not ultra vires of the Khwaja Fareed University

of Engineering and Information Technology, Rahim Yar Khan Act 2014.

CREDITS: This Code of Ethics & Conduct borrows heavily from the Code of Ethics of National University of Sciences & Technology, Pakistan which in turn is based on a number of other documents that are cited therein.